Centering the error makes the posterior mean optimal

Average the centered expansion Previous slide: pointwise squared-error expansion

$$\|z-a\|^2 = \|r\|^2 + 2r^T(m-a) + \|m-a\|^2$$

Take $E[\cdot\,|y]$; $m-a$ is fixed

$$E[r|y] = E[z|y] - m = 0$$

$$E\big[r^T(m-a)|y\big] = E[r|y]^T(m-a) = 0$$

With $V = \mathrm{Cov}[z|y] = E[rr^T|y]$

$$E\big[\|r\|^2|y\big] = \sum_{j=1}^{d} E\big[r_j^2|y\big] = \operatorname{tr} V$$

Conditional squared-error risk

$$R(a|y) = \operatorname{tr} V + \|m-a\|^2$$

Optimal reconstruction

$$\|m-a\|^2 \geq 0 \quad \text{with equality iff} \quad a = m$$

$$a^*(y) = m = E[z|y], \quad \min_a R(a|y) = \operatorname{tr} V$$

align(center)[For the conditional Gaussian: $\quad a^*(y) = \mu_{z|y}, \quad \min_a R(a|y) = \operatorname{tr} \Sigma_{z|y}$]

- Risk is residual uncertainty plus the squared distance of the chosen estimate from the mean.
- The conditional mean minimizes model expected squared error.